non-metallic containers. These containers are used because they transmit the microwaves but do not absorb or reflect them.

Eg: Cake can be baked in microwave oven.

DO YOU KNOW?

Do not try recipes that require a lot of water such as pasta in microwave because they do not cook well.

b. Solar Cooking: Solar cooking is a very simple technique that makes use of sunlight or solar energy.

Solar cooker consists of a well-insulated box which is painted black inside and covered with one or more transparent covers. These covers allow the radiation from the sun to come inside the box but do not allow the heat from the hot black absorbing plate to come out of the box.

Because of this, temperature up to 140°C can be obtained which is adequate for cooking. Solar cooking is free of scorching and oozing of contents.

Eg: Rice



▲ Plate 3.16 Solar Cooker

3.3 Effects of Cooking on Nutrients

Eating nutritious food can improve health and energy levels. The way of cooking food has a major effect on the nutrient contents. Exposure to heat, light or oxygen will alter the nutrients in food.

The following nutrients are often reduced during cooking.

- **Water Soluble Vitamin:** Vitamin C and vitamins B – thiamine, riboflavin, niacin, pantothenic acid, pyridoxine, folic acid and cyanocobalamin.

3.3.1 Guidelines for Nutrients Conservation

Conservation of nutrients means saving nutrients during the process of preparation and cooking of food.

To conserve nutrients in food items the following techniques can be practiced:

1. Wash vegetables before cutting
2. Cut vegetables into large pieces just before cooking
3. Scrape the peels of vegetable as thin as possible because vitamins and minerals are found just under the skin of the vegetables.
4. Soak dry pulses with enough water prior to cooking.
5. Use just enough water for cooking.
6. Cooking in a pan which has a well-fitting lid avoids nutritional loss.
7. Do not overcook the food.

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